Hustle Hive CIC – Financial Operations Policy

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Finance lead	Kieron Davis, Director (monthly review by Gavin Copland, Director)
Bank	ANNA Business, account in the name of Hustle Hive CIC
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner if our funding, structure or the law changes

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how Hustle Hive CIC manages its money so that it is used properly, for our community purpose and as funders intended, and so that we can show this to funders, commissioners, Companies House and the Regulator of Community Interest Companies.

2. Governance and roles

Who	Responsibilities
Board of Directors	Overall responsibility for our finances; approve the annual budget, accounts and any spending above the limits in section 6; review the finance report at every monthly Board meeting

Who	Responsibilities
Kieron Davis, finance lead	Runs day-to-day finances, bookings, invoicing, purchasing and grant reporting within this policy; keeps the deadlines calendar
Gavin Copland, finance review	Reviews and signs the bank statements and reconciliation every month; checks and approves any payment to Kieron Davis
Our accountant	Prepares annual accounts and tax returns, advises the Board, and reviews all payments to Directors as part of the year-end accounts
Staff and volunteers	Follow this policy when handling money and report any concerns

Dividing these duties means that no one person controls a transaction from start to finish, and that the Director who did not make a payment checks it, and our accountant reviews payments to Directors each year.

3. Planning and reporting

- The Board approves an annual budget before the start of each financial year, and a separate budget for each funded project.
- The operational Directors prepare a monthly finance report showing income and spending against budget, the bank balance, money owed to and by us, and a cash flow forecast for the next 3 months.
- Every Board meeting reviews the finance report. Any significant variance from budget is explained and acted on.

4. Statutory compliance

We meet all our legal filing and tax duties on time:

What	Who to	When
Annual accounts	Companies House	Within 9 months of the end of our financial year
Community interest company report (form CIC34), including any Directors' pay	Companies House, with the accounts	Each year with the accounts

What	Who to	When
Confirmation statement	Companies House	At least once every 12 months
Corporation Tax return	HMRC	Within 12 months of the end of our accounting period
PAYE and payroll (if we employ staff)	HMRC	Every time staff are paid
VAT registration	HMRC	If our taxable turnover goes over the VAT threshold. We monitor turnover every month

Kieron Davis keeps a calendar of these deadlines and checks they are met.

5. Income

Fees and invoices

- Holiday club, workshop and course fees are paid online through our booking system wherever possible, and the payments are matched against bookings every month.
- Schools and local authorities are invoiced for placements in line with the agreed placement terms, and unpaid invoices are chased after 30 days.
- Refunds follow our published booking terms, and any refund over £100 needs a second Director's approval.

Cash

We avoid handling cash where we can. Where cash is taken, for example at a market stall or event, two people count it, record the amount and sign the record. It is kept secure and paid into the bank within 5 working days. Cash is never used to pay for anything before it is banked.

Grants and restricted funds

- Every grant is recorded with its purpose, budget, conditions and reporting dates.
- Restricted funds, such as our National Lottery Community Fund grant for Makers to Market, are only spent on the purpose and budget the funder approved, and are tracked separately in our accounts.
- Any change to how a grant is spent is agreed with the funder in writing beforehand.
- Funder reports are accurate, on time and backed by records. We return any unspent funds if the grant terms require it.

- Donations and sponsorship are recorded, and any conditions attached are followed.

6. Spending

All spending must be for our purposes, within budget, good value for money and supported by an invoice or receipt.

Authorisation limits

Amount (per purchase or invoice)	Who can approve
Up to £250, within budget	One operational Director
£250 to £2,000, within budget	Both Directors
Over £2,000, anything outside budget, or any new contract or lease	The Board
Any payment to a Director, or to someone connected to a Director	The other Director, with the payment reported to our accountant and disclosed in our annual CIC report

No one may approve a payment to themselves. Splitting a purchase to get under a limit is not allowed.

Purchasing

For purchases over £1,000, we get at least two quotes, or record why that wasn't possible. Purchases over £5,000 need three quotes. We follow any extra purchasing rules in our grant agreements.

Banking and payments

- Our bank account is with ANNA Business, in the name of Hustle Hive CIC. Account details are kept securely and shared only with Directors, our accountant and auditors.
- Online banking uses two-factor authentication. Passwords and cards are never shared, and cards are only used by the named holder for approved spending.
- Where the banking system allows, payments need a second Director's approval.
- New suppliers' bank details, and any change to them, are checked by phone using a number we already hold, never only by email, to prevent fraud.
- Gavin Copland reviews the bank statements every month and signs a check of the reconciliation.

Directors' pay and conflicts of interest

Directors are not paid for being Directors. Directors may be paid for delivering our programmes only where the payment is agreed in a written contract approved by the other Director and reviewed by our accountant, at a fair rate, included in relevant budgets and funding applications, and reported in our CIC34 report. Directors declare any personal or business interest that could conflict with their role, and do not take part in decisions about it. Declarations are recorded in Board minutes and a register of interests.

Expenses

Expenses are paid back only for reasonable, approved spending for our work, with a receipt, and claimed within one month. Mileage is paid at the HMRC approved rate. Claims are approved by a Director other than the person claiming.

Gifts and hospitality

Staff and Directors must not accept gifts or hospitality that could influence a decision. Anything worth more than £20 is recorded and reported to the Board. We do not offer or accept bribes.

7. Assets

Equipment costing over £250, such as 3D printers, laptops, heat presses and cutting machines, is recorded on an asset register with its cost, date, funder (if grant-funded), location and condition. The register is checked every year. Assets are only used for our work, kept secure and insured. Assets bought with grant funding are only sold or disposed of as the grant terms allow.

8. Reserves

We aim to build and keep unrestricted reserves equal to at least 3 months of essential running costs, such as rent, insurance and core staffing, so we can manage gaps in income. The Board reviews the reserves target every year.

9. Financial risks

The Board reviews our main financial risks every year, including cash flow, relying on a small number of funders or commissioners, late payment, unexpected costs and disruption to our premises or equipment, and agrees actions to reduce them.

10. Preventing fraud

We do not tolerate fraud, theft, bribery or misuse of funds. Our main protections are the division of duties in this policy, the authorisation limits, monthly independent review of the bank account, checks on supplier bank details and full record keeping. Anyone who suspects fraud must report it to the Director not involved, to our accountant, or under our Whistleblowing Policy. Suspected fraud is investigated and may be reported to the police, Action Fraud and our funders.

11. Records

We keep complete financial records, including invoices, receipts, bank statements, payroll, grant documents and the asset register, for at least 6 years from the end of the financial year, or longer if a funder requires it, in line with our Records Retention Policy.

12. Accounts and independent review

Our accountant prepares our annual accounts. We arrange an independent examination or audit where the law, a funder or the Board requires it, and act on any recommendations.

13. Asset lock

As a community interest company, our assets are protected by an asset lock. They can only be used for the benefit of the community, or transferred to another asset-locked body, such as another CIC or a charity, as our articles of association and CIC law allow. This includes on dissolution.

14. Review

This policy is reviewed every year, and sooner if our funding, structure or the law changes.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Whistleblowing Policy, Records Retention Policy and staff code of conduct.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director, finance review		
Kieron Davis	Director, finance lead		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		